QUEENS PEACE PALACE

THE GRIEF RECLAMATION

A Guided Reflection for Honoring the Loss,
Making Room for Love & Learning to Carry What Remains

FEEL. HONOR. CARRY.

TO THY OWN SELF BE TRUE

The Inner Work Collection

Before You Begin

Grief is a response to loss. It may follow the death of someone you love, the end of a relationship, the loss of a job, a major life transition, or another change that alters life as you knew it. Grief can bring tears, anger, numbness, withdrawal, longing, relief, confusion, emptiness - sometimes several of them in the same day.

There is no single correct order for grief and no schedule you are required to follow. The commonly known experiences of denial, anger, bargaining, depression and acceptance can be useful language, but they are not a staircase you must climb in sequence. You may revisit feelings, skip some entirely, or experience emotions that do not fit neatly into any category.

> **This workbook is not asking you to "get over" what you lost.**
> It is an invitation to make room for what is true now: the loss, the love, the change, the memories, the anger, the questions - and the life that is still unfolding around them.

A note on support

This workbook is for personal reflection and education. It is not therapy, diagnosis, or crisis care. Grief can become especially heavy after traumatic loss or when it significantly disrupts daily life; if reflection feels overwhelming, pause and consider support from a licensed mental-health professional, grief specialist, or another qualified provider.

YOUR INTENTION

What would you like to give yourself permission to feel, remember, understand or carry differently?

What changed?

Grief is not limited to death. Sometimes we grieve a person, relationship, identity, future, home, opportunity, season of life, sense of safety, or version of ourselves. Naming the loss helps make the invisible weight more visible.

I am grieving...

What changed because of this loss?

What do you miss most?

What do you NOT miss - or what became easier - that you feel complicated admitting?

Where are you today?

Grief can move. You may feel accepting one morning and furious that evening. You may laugh and then cry. You may have a peaceful week followed by a difficult anniversary, song, smell, place or memory. Movement does not mean you are going backward.

Today, my grief feels most like...

- ■ Disbelief or numbness
- ■ Anger
- ■ Longing
- ■ Bargaining or “what if” thinking
- ■ Deep sadness
- ■ Acceptance
- ■ Relief
- ■ Confusion
- ■ Loneliness
- ■ Gratitude
- ■ Love
- ■ Something I cannot name yet: _____

What tends to change the shape or intensity of your grief?

What do you wish people understood about the way YOU grieve?

There is no prize for grieving correctly.
Your emotions do not have to arrive in a socially convenient order.

What does absence feel like in your actual life?

Loss often lives in ordinary moments: the call you cannot make, the chair that stays empty, the routine that changed, the future plan that no longer exists. Sometimes the smallest missing thing carries the largest ache.

A moment when I notice the absence most is...

A routine, place, object, song, smell or time of day that brings the grief close is...

Something I still instinctively want to tell, show or share with them is...

What is hardest about the permanence or change of this loss?

What remains?

When grief follows death or separation, the relationship may change form without becoming meaningless. Memory, influence, language, traditions, lessons, humor, music, objects and love can continue to have a place in your life.

If you are grieving a person, describe them in one sentence:

What would you want other people to know about them?

A memory I want to keep close is...

Something they gave me - emotionally, practically, spiritually or through who they were - that still lives in me is...

Continuing love is not the same as refusing reality.
You can accept that something changed and still allow the relationship, memory or meaning to matter.

Some grief carries unfinished conversation.

Loss can leave behind words that never found their moment: love, anger, gratitude, apology, disappointment, questions, ordinary updates, or one last joke. You do not need an answer in order to give those words somewhere to go.

What I wish I had said is...

What I wish I could ask is...

What I hope they knew - even if I never got to say it perfectly - is...

If this loss is not a death, what unfinished truth still needs to be acknowledged?

Grief does not require a perfect relationship.

You can love someone and be angry with them. Miss them and feel relief. Treasure what was beautiful and resent what hurt. Grief does not erase the complexity of the relationship, and complexity does not cancel love.

Two feelings that seem contradictory but are both true for me are...

Something I am angry about is...

Something I am grateful for is...

What feeling have you been judging yourself for having?

You do not have to clean up the relationship after loss.
You are allowed to remember the whole truth.

Who are you after this?

Grief does not only change what is outside of you. It can change priorities, identity, faith, relationships, routines, tolerance, tenderness, fear and the way you understand time.

Since this loss, I have changed in these ways...

A part of me that feels older, softer, harder or different now is...

Something I understand about life now that I did not understand before is...

What part of yourself are you still getting to know?

What are you trying to change in a past that cannot be reopened?

Grief often creates an endless editing room: *I should have called. I should have known. I should not have said that. What if I had gone? What if I had stayed?* Some regret may contain a real lesson. But hindsight also knows things the version of you living that day could not know.

The “if only” or “what if” I replay most is...

What did I actually know at the time?

What am I expecting past-me to have predicted?

Is there a lesson I want to carry forward without sentencing myself forever?

Regret can teach without becoming a life sentence.
You are allowed to wish something had been different and still have compassion for the person you were inside that moment.

How do you want to remember?

Memory can hurt because it brings you close to what is gone. Over time, some memories may also become places of connection, gratitude, laughter or tenderness. You do not need to force that shift; you can simply notice what you want to preserve.

A memory that still makes me smile is...

A story I never want forgotten is...

Something small about them or that season that other people might not know is...

A tradition, phrase, recipe, song, object, place or practice I may want to carry forward is...

What helps when grief gets loud?

Some days will ask more of you than others. Anniversaries, birthdays, holidays, familiar places, unexpected reminders and ordinary exhaustion can all make grief feel newly immediate. A hard day does not erase the healing that happened before it.

Something that helps me on a hard day is...

Someone I can reach toward is...

Something I need LESS of when grief is heavy is...

Something I need MORE of is...

What can I prepare for an anniversary, birthday, holiday or other tender date?

A difficult grief day is not a failed healing day.
Sometimes the kindest thing you can do is reduce the demands and let the day be what it is.

What would living again mean to you?

People sometimes fear that laughing, loving, succeeding, traveling, dating, celebrating or feeling peaceful means they are betraying the person or life they lost. But continuing your life does not require reducing the significance of what came before.

Something I have felt guilty for enjoying since the loss is...

What am I afraid moving forward might mean?

What if moving forward could mean carrying love WITH me rather than leaving it behind?

One part of life I would like to slowly make room for again is...

Give grief room without giving it every room.

These statements are not instructions to be positive. They are reminders that grief and life can exist beside one another.

“I am allowed to grieve in my own way and in my own time.”

“Love can remain even when a relationship changes form.”

“I can miss what was and still participate in what is.”

“A hard day does not mean I am back at the beginning.”

“I can carry memory without making pain my only connection.”

“Moving forward does not require forgetting.”

Write three statements that speak directly to YOUR grief.

1.

2.

3.

What do you want the love to become?

Grief changes over time, but meaning can continue to grow. You may carry the person, relationship or season forward through the way you love, create, choose, remember, protect your time, honor your values or live more fully.

What this loss taught me about love is...

What it taught me about time is...

Something I want to do differently because I know life can change is...

A quality, lesson or love I want to carry forward is...

One way I can honor what mattered without making my whole life a memorial is...

THE PALACE CHECK-IN

Ask: “Am I letting myself feel what is here? Am I allowing memory to contain more than pain? Am I giving myself permission to live without requiring love to disappear first?”

RETURN TO YOURSELF

You do not have to stop loving what you lost to keep living.

Some love ends. Some love changes form. Some love becomes part of who you are.

There is no deadline for missing someone. There is no betrayal in laughter returning. There is no requirement that acceptance feel peaceful every day. You are allowed to carry grief and joy in the same life - to remember, to ache, to love, to change, and to keep becoming.

Remember:
Healing grief is not proving that the loss matters less. It is learning how to let your life become larger around what will always matter.

Need support going deeper?

If this reflection uncovered something you would like support navigating, Queens Peace Palace offers private Spiritual Life Coaching for clarity, self-trust, relationships, transitions and personal growth. For grief that feels overwhelming, traumatic, or significantly disrupts daily life, consider working with an appropriately qualified grief or mental-health professional.

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